

Agent Monitor

for BES Clients

Installation Guide

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Author	Mike Consuegra

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What You Get

You'll receive the dashboard tarball plus the Health Agent bundles for the platforms you intend to monitor. The optional DMZ Forwarder is only needed when some endpoints can't reach the dashboard directly.

File	Purpose	Install On
AgentMonitor-<version>.tar.gz	Dashboard appliance: web UI, ingest API, PostgreSQL schema, installer	Ubuntu Server (dedicated host)
agentmonitor-linux-<version>.tar.gz	Health Agent for Linux endpoints	Linux host with BES Client
AgentMon-Agent-<version>-windows.zip	Health Agent for Windows endpoints	Windows host with BES Client
AgentMonitorForwarder-Setup.exe	DMZ Forwarder (optional relay)	Windows DMZ relay host

How agents enroll. The dashboard generates a small signed file called a charter (dashboard.charter) that you download once from the web UI and place next to the agent installer. The installer reads it, verifies it, and enrolls the endpoint. The charter is created in Part 2 and used in Part 3.

Architecture Overview

The dashboard holds the endpoint history, the tenant configuration, and the web UI. The Health Agent runs on each endpoint, performs a set of local checks, and reports the results back to the dashboard. The optional DMZ Forwarder relays agent traffic for endpoints in networks that can't reach the dashboard directly. The diagram below illustrates how the components interact across your environment.

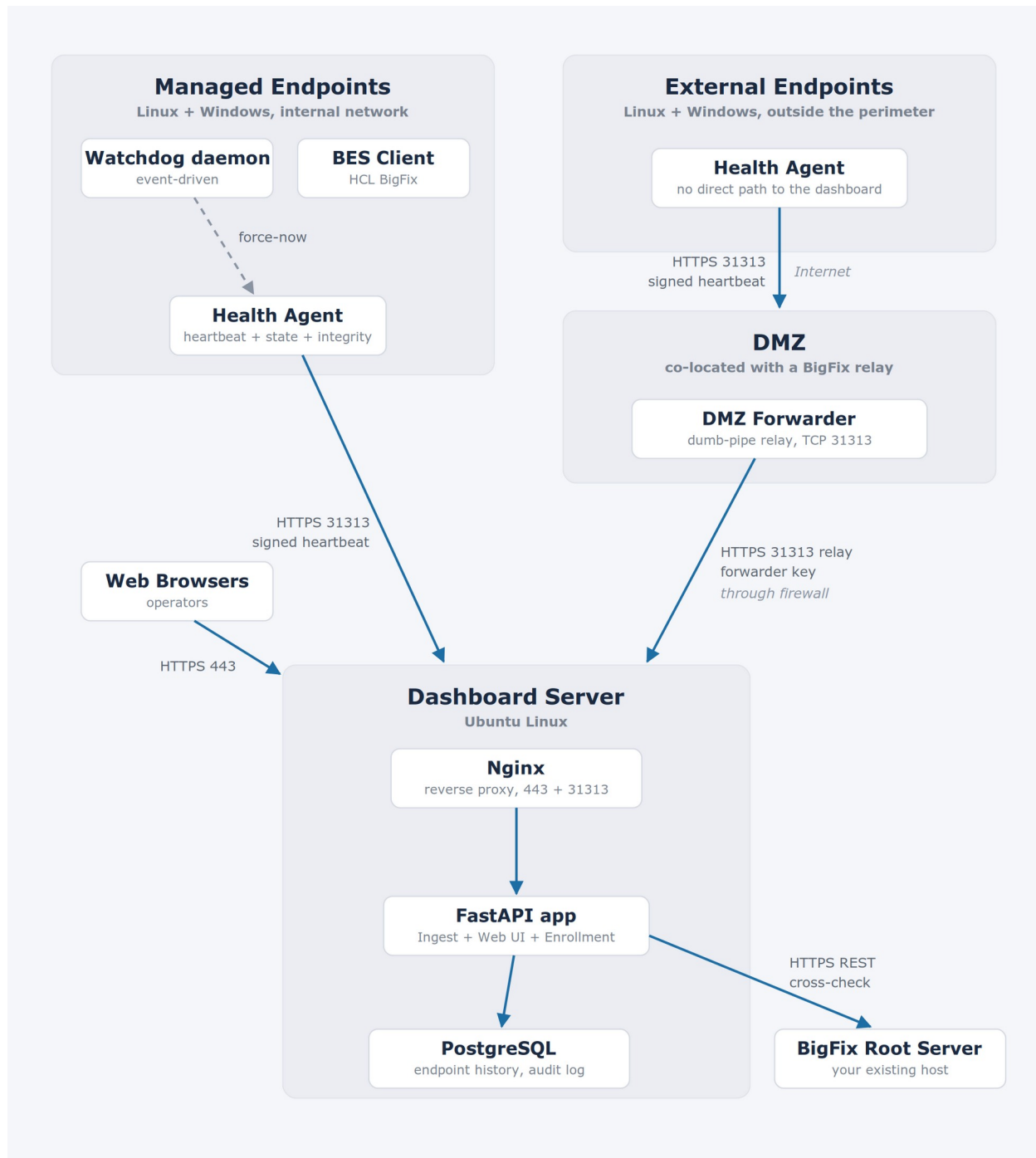


Figure 1: Agent Monitor system architecture

Data Flow

- **Health Agent** The agent runs on a schedule on each endpoint (a systemd timer on Linux, a scheduled task on Windows) and posts a heartbeat to the dashboard. Every heartbeat is signed with a per-endpoint keypair; the default algorithm is post-quantum ML-DSA-65.
- **Watchdog** A watchdog process on each endpoint reacts to the BES Client stopping or restarting and triggers an immediate agent run. On Linux it's event-driven and reacts within seconds; on Windows it polls the Service Control Manager on a configurable interval (60 seconds by default).
- **BigFix REST cross-check** On a schedule the dashboard calls the BigFix REST API and reconciles what BigFix sees against what the Health Agent reports. This is how it distinguishes an actual silent agent from an endpoint BigFix no longer sees, and how it populates the Disagreement card. An endpoint that stops reporting is marked silent after 24 hours by default, and promoted to Disagreement after 72 hours if BigFix still corroborates it. Both thresholds are configurable.
- **Web UI** Operators use a browser over HTTPS on port 443.
- **Report encryption (Strongbox)** Reports can optionally be encrypted end to end so a middle man can't read them. This is a per-tenant policy that *ships off* by default.
- **Boot beacon** On the first agent run after a reboot, the agent sends a one-time boot beacon so a mass reboot clears any false silent state quickly without overwhelming the server.
- **Self-check cadence** Between watchdog-triggered runs the agent self-checks on an internal interval that defaults to 15 minutes and is configurable per endpoint from the dashboard. Once every 24 hours it sends a heartbeat even if nothing has changed, so a quiet, but healthy endpoint never drifts into the silent bucket.
- **DMZ Forwarder** The optional forwarder is a passthru pipe. It accepts agent reports and relays them to the dashboard, never reading or altering report contents. Agents given a forwarder address try the dashboard directly first, fall back to the forwarder, and store locally if neither is reachable.

Ports

Ports used by the system:

- Operator web UI (browser to dashboard): 443 (HTTPS).
- Agent and forwarder traffic to the dashboard: TCP/31313 (HTTPS). This is the platform's dedicated machine-to-machine port and the only port the dashboard serves agent traffic on; the port is fixed, not configurable. The operator web UI is separate, on 443.
- Agent traffic to the DMZ Forwarder (inbound): TCP/31313.
- Dashboard to BigFix REST API: 52311 (default).
- Dashboard application (internal): 127.0.0.1:5001, loopback only, the Nginx upstream.

Prerequisites

Dashboard Server (Ubuntu)

Requirement	Details
Operating System	Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS or 26.04 LTS (amd64)
Access	Root or sudo
RAM	Minimum 8 GB. 16 GB for 25,000–100,000 agents. 32 GB and a dedicated PostgreSQL data partition above 100,000, or for heavy concurrent operator queries or very short self-check intervals.
Disk	Minimum 20 GB free on the partition that holds /opt and /var
Disk (Large Environment)	Add ~1MB of data-partition headroom per additional endpoint beyond 25,000. Environments above 50,000 should plan on 100GB or a dedicated PostgreSQL data partition.
Network (outbound)	Internet access during installation (for apt packages)
Network (REST)	Must reach the BigFix Root Server REST API
Network (ingest)	Must be reachable from every endpoint on TCP/31313
Ports	443 (HTTPS) to users; TCP/31313 (HTTPS) from endpoints and forwarders.

Initial setup. The installer brings up PostgreSQL, Nginx, Python, and all dependencies. You don't need to pre-install anything beyond base Ubuntu Server image although it does detect if you already installed them.

Managed Endpoints

Platform	Versions
Linux	Ubuntu 22.04 / 24.04 / 26.04, RHEL 8 / 9 (systemd required)
Windows	Windows 10 / 11, Windows Server 2016 / 2019 / 2022 / 2025

The endpoint must already be enrolled in your BigFix environment (the BES Client must be installed and reporting). Agent Monitor doesn't replace the BES Client; it watches it.

BigFix Operator Account

The dashboard requires a BigFix operator account to perform its cross-check. This account **must be a Master Operator** (MO). A non-MO account will produce incomplete cross-check results.

Why Master Operator. The cross-check relies on the BigFix REST API returning the full Computer list plus **Last Report Time** and online status for every endpoint, regardless of which BigFix site it belongs to. Only the Master Operator role has that scope.

Part 1: Dashboard Server Installation (Ubuntu)

These steps install the dashboard appliance on a clean Ubuntu Server host. The installer is interactive and prompts for the values it can't guess.

Step 1: Transfer the Dashboard Package

Transfer the dashboard tarball to your Ubuntu server. SCP is the simplest path:

From your workstation

```
scp AgentMonitor-<version>.tar.gz user@your-server:/tmp/
```

Step 2: Extract the Package

On the server

```
ssh user@your-server
cd /tmp
tar -xzf AgentMonitor-<version>.tar.gz
cd AgentMonitor-<version>
```

You should see the following:

Tarball layout

```
AgentMonitor-<version>/
  app/                  # Application code (FastAPI routers, models,
services)              # services)
  static/               # Web frontend assets (JS, CSS, images)
  scripts/              # Compile and helper scripts
  migrations/           # Versioned schema migrations
  install.sh            # Automated installer
  database.sql           # Initial schema
  nginx-bigfix-health-archive # Nginx site template
  requirements.txt       # Python dependencies
```

Step 3: Run the Installer

bash

```
sudo bash install.sh
```

The installer prints a banner and begins the installation in stages.

```
=====
Agent Monitor for BES Clients – Installer
Version 2.6.5
=====

[20:50:55] === Pre-flight Checks ===
Detected: Ubuntu 26.04 (resolute)

[20:50:55] === Prerequisite Check ===
Found: curl
Found: python3
Found: openssl
Found: free
Found: lsblk
Found: nproc
Found: useradd
Found: find
All prerequisites satisfied.
Python 3.14 OK (>=3.12).
Memory: 7424MB available
Disk: 14689MB free on /opt

[20:50:56] === Configuration ===

Provide the following. Press Enter to accept defaults in [brackets].

--- Web Admin Account ---
Admin username [admin]: 
```

Step 4: Enter Admin Account Details

The installer prompts for the initial administrator account:

- **Admin username** The username you will use to log into the web UI (for example, `admin`)
- **Admin password** Entered twice for confirmation. Choose a strong password; it is stored hashed.
- **Admin email** Optional. Required for password reset and admin email notifications.

```
[20:50:56] === Configuration ===

Provide the following. Press Enter to accept defaults in [brackets].

--- Web Admin Account ---
Admin username [admin]: 
Admin password: *****
Confirm Admin password: *****
Admin email (optional, press Enter to skip): 
WARNING: No admin email set. Password reset and email notifications for the admin account will be unavailable until you set one via the web UI (Administration > User Management).
```

Step 5: Database User

The installer creates a dedicated PostgreSQL role for the application and generates its password automatically (the password is encrypted into the configuration file). You're only asked for the role name; press Enter to accept the default (bfhealthapp) unless you have a naming convention to follow.

Step 6: SSL Certificate Configuration

By default the installer asks whether you want to use your own certificate and generates a self-signed certificate if you don't have your own.

- **Answer N (the default)** to use the generated self-signed certificate. Browsers show a one-time warning you can dismiss.
- **Answer y** to supply the paths to your own certificate (.crt) and private key (.key). The installer copies them into place and configures Nginx to use them. Use this in production.

```
--- Database ---
Database password: [auto-generated, will be encrypted in .env]
Database user [bfhealthapp]:

--- SSL Certificate ---
A self-signed certificate will be generated by default.
Do you have a CA certificate that you would like to use instead? (y/N) [N]:
```

Step 7: Agent Reporting Address

The installer asks for the URL that endpoints will use to reach this dashboard. This value becomes the default ingest URL included in the charter file. The port is fixed at the platform port 31313 and can't be changed: the suggested default is https://<this host's address>, and the installer normalizes whatever you enter onto :31313. Set the host part to how endpoints actually reach the dashboard (a stable DNS name is preferred; an IP works if it never changes).

```
--- Agent Reporting Address ---
The address agents report to, baked into every charter you generate.
WARNING: This value must be reachable by EVERY endpoint across your network.
WARNING: Use a stable DNS name where possible; an IP works only if it never changes.
Dashboard URL for agents [https://192.168.0.46:31313]:
```

Step 8: Dependency Check

Since there are certain dependencies that have to be downloaded, the installer will check whether the versions about to be downloaded are the same as the ones this version of the platform was built with. If it detects that the available dependency versions are newer it will give you the option to install the exact versions used in the build or the newest versions available.

```
=====
Dependency version check
=====
This release was built and tested with specific Python library
versions. Your system would now install newer ones for:

anyio                tested 4.14.0          ->  available 4.14.2
APScheduler          tested 3.11.2          ->  available 3.11.3
cffi                 tested 2.0.0           ->  available 2.1.0
charset-normalizer   tested 3.4.7           ->  available 3.4.9
click                tested 8.4.1           ->  available 8.4.2
fastapi              tested 0.138.0         ->  available 0.139.2
greenlet             tested 3.5.2           ->  available 3.5.3
pillow               tested 12.2.0          ->  available 12.3.0
typing_extensions    tested 4.15.0          ->  available 4.16.0
tzlocal              tested 5.4.3           ->  available 5.4.4
uvicorn              tested 0.49.0          ->  available 0.51.0

These newer versions were not tested with this build. Choose:

[T] Install the exact tested versions    (recommended for production)
[C] Continue with the latest versions    (not tested with this build)
[A] Abort the installation

Your choice [T/C/A]: █
```

Step 9: Performance Tuning

The installer will auto detect the host's hardware specs and make a recommendation about tuning the database and kernel :

- **PostgreSQL:** The installer will make recommendations about tuning PostgreSQL for performance
- **Kernel Virtual Memory:** The installer will recommend a memory management setting

```
[03:11:06] === PostgreSQL Performance Tuning ===  
  
Detected hardware:  
Total RAM:    7424 MB (~7 GB)  
CPU cores:    4  
PG storage:   SSD  
  
Recommended PostgreSQL settings for this server:  
shared_buffers      = 1856MB  
effective_cache_size = 4454MB  
work_mem            = 16MB  
maintenance_work_mem = 256MB  
random_page_cost    = 1.1  
effective_io_concurrency = 200  
max_worker_processes = 4  
max_parallel_workers = 4  
max_parallel_workers_per_gather = 2  
max_parallel_maintenance_workers = 2  
wal_buffers         = 16MB  
checkpoint_completion_target = 0.9  
  
Plus kernel: vm.swappiness = 10  
  
Apply these PostgreSQL tuning settings now? [Y/n]: ☐
```

It's recommended to accept the tuning parameters for better application performance.

The installer then runs through its stages automatically:

1. Install system packages (PostgreSQL, Nginx, Python, build tools)
2. Create the application user (bfhealthapp) and the directory tree
3. Set up the Python virtual environment and install dependencies
4. Deploy the application files and install the integrity manifest
5. Initialize the database, load the schema, and apply all migrations
6. Configure SSL and Nginx (HTTP redirects to HTTPS on 443) and write the encrypted configuration file
7. Create and start the two systemd services: the API service (bigfix-health-archive) and the scheduler service (bigfix-health-archive-scheduler)
8. Start the application and run a health check

When complete, you will see a success message with the dashboard URL and the service status reading "active (running)."

```
=====
Installation Complete! (v2.6.5)
=====
```

Access the application:

```
URL:      https://192.168.0.46
Username:  admin
Password:  (as configured during install)
```

Service management:

```
Status:  sudo systemctl status bigfix-health-archive bigfix-health-archive-scheduler
Restart: sudo systemctl restart bigfix-health-archive bigfix-health-archive-scheduler
API log:  sudo journalctl -u bigfix-health-archive -f
Sched log: sudo journalctl -u bigfix-health-archive-scheduler -f
```

Important paths:

```
App:      /opt/bigfix-health-archive/
Config:    /opt/bigfix-health-archive/config/.env
Data:      /opt/bigfix-health-archive/data/diagnostics/
Backups:   /opt/bigfix-health-archive/backups/
```

This is a fresh install. Next steps:

- **If migrating from another Agent Monitor server:**
 1. Log in here with the throwaway admin credentials you just set
 2. Administration → System Settings → Backup & Restore
 3. SERVER MIGRATION → IMPORT MIGRATION, upload your .bch-mig
 4. After import completes, restart both services and log in with the SOURCE server's admin credentials (yours will be overwritten)
- **If standing up a new deployment:**
 - Administration → System Settings → Connections to configure BigFix REST
 - Administration → API Keys to mint agent credentials

Self-signed certificate – your browser will show a warning on first visit. Replace via System Settings → Certificates when ready.

Warmup window. After a restart or a fresh install, the dashboard takes about 30 to 60 seconds to warm up under load. If your first browser hit returns a 502 Bad Gateway, wait 60 seconds and refresh. A real failure shows up in the application log and in systemctl status.

Part 2: First Login and Configuration

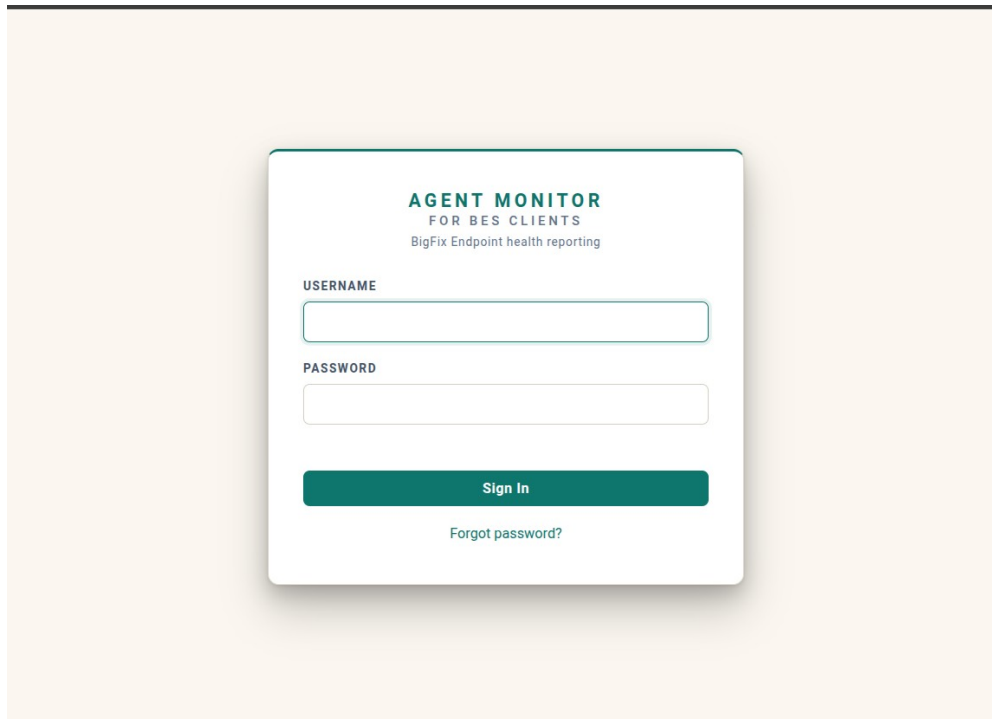
After the installer finishes, log into the web UI and complete the one-time configuration: verify the BigFix connection, set your report encryption policy if you want it, and generate the charter you will use to deploy agents. You don't create tenants by hand; a tenant is created automatically the first time an endpoint reports in, keyed to the BigFix environment it belongs to.

Step 1: Open the Web UI

In your browser

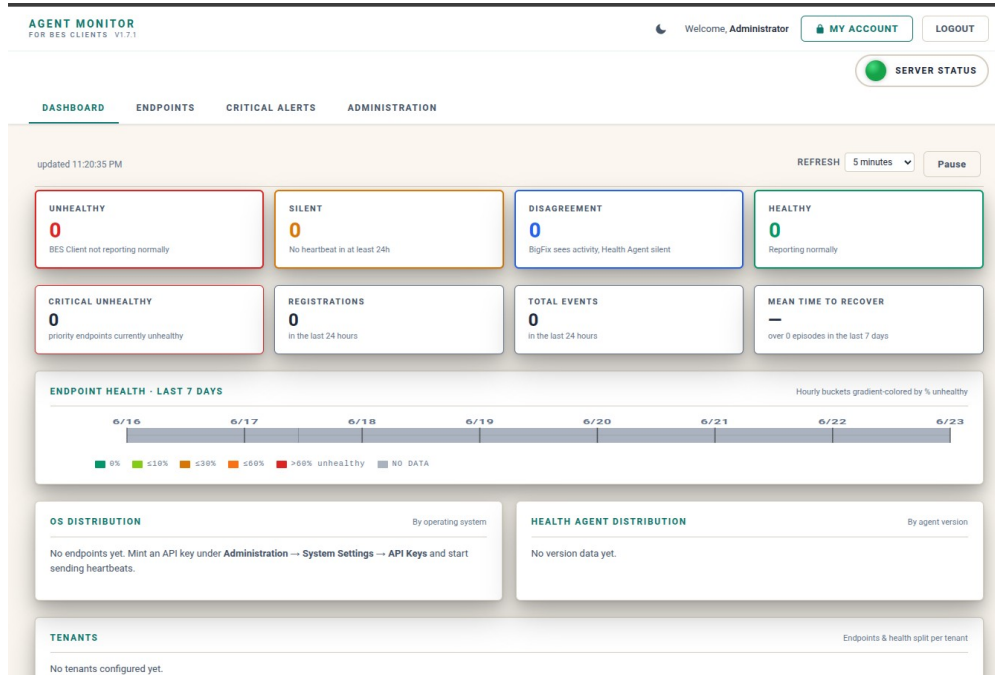
```
https://your-server-ip
```

If you used the self-signed certificate option in Part 1, your browser will show a security warning the first time. Click through to proceed. The connection is still encrypted, and the warning will disappear once you replace the certificate with one your browser trusts.

The image shows a login interface for 'AGENT MONITOR FOR BES CLIENTS'. The interface is centered on a light beige background. It features a white card with a thin teal border. At the top of the card, the text 'AGENT MONITOR' is in bold teal, followed by 'FOR BES CLIENTS' in smaller teal, and 'BigFix Endpoint health reporting' in even smaller teal. Below this, there are two input fields: 'USERNAME' and 'PASSWORD', both with teal borders. A teal 'Sign In' button is positioned below the password field. At the bottom of the card, there is a link that says 'Forgot password?' in teal.

Step 2: Log In

Enter the admin username and password you created during installation. The first login lands you on the Dashboard tab, which will show zeros for every counter because no endpoints have reported yet.



Step 3: Generate and Download the Charter

The charter is the single file you hand to the agent installer. It carries the dashboard ingest URL, a new enrollment key, the anchor fingerprint the agent assigns its trust to, your encryption enforcement setting, and (when a DMZ Forwarder exists) the forwarder trust bundle.

To generate it, go to Administration > System Settings > Agent Builds. In the DEPLOYMENT: CHARTER section, confirm the Dashboard ingest URL, optionally set an Enrollment key name, leave Enforce anchor verification (recommended) checked, and click GENERATE & DOWNLOAD CHARTER. Your browser downloads a file named dashboard.charter.

DEPLOYMENT: CHARTER ?

Generates a fresh enrollment key and bundles it with this dashboard's address and anchor, signed by the anchor. Hand it out next to the generic installer; the endpoint verifies it and lands here automatically.

Dashboard ingest URL

Enrollment key name (optional)

☒ Enforce anchor verification (recommended)

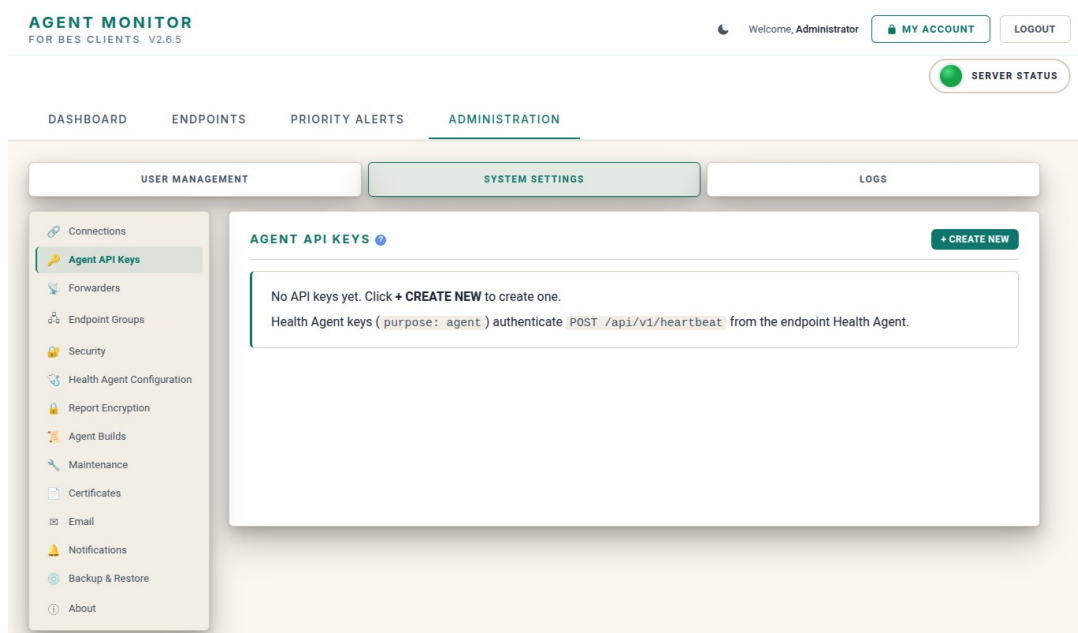
GENERATE & DOWNLOAD CHARTER

Keep the charter file safe. The enrollment key exists only inside the charter and is never stored on the dashboard in the clear. One charter serves your whole environment; the tenant an endpoint belongs to is determined automatically when it first reports (using the actionsite.afxm file).

Step 4: Create an Agent API Key (Optional)

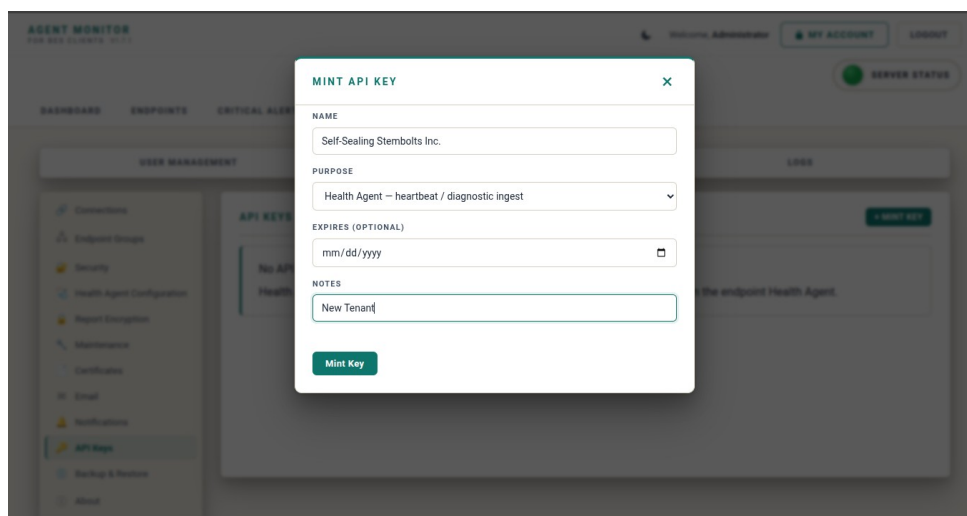
Generating a charter in Step 3 creates its own enrollment key automatically, so a separate API key is only needed if you want a named key for integrations or your own tracking. To create one:

1. Administration > System Settings > Agent API Keys

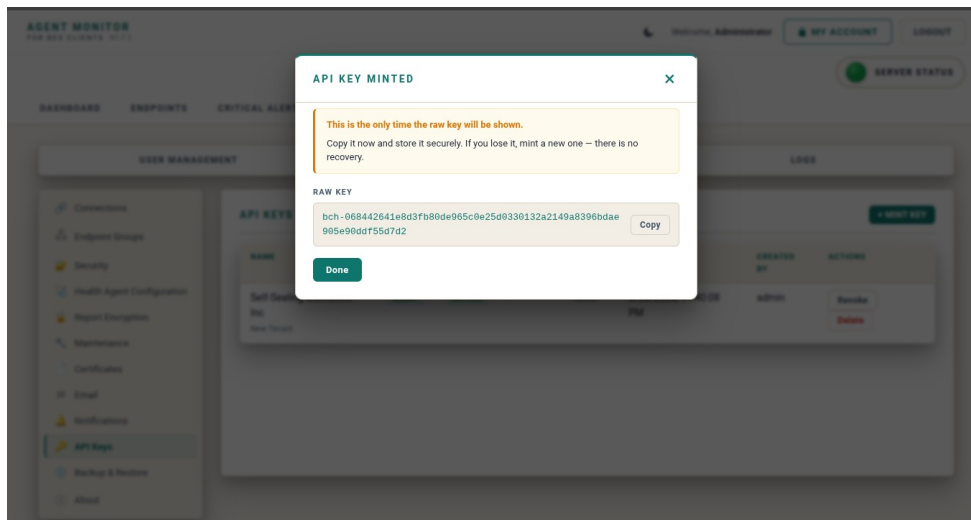


2. Click +

CREATE NEW and fill in Name, Purpose (Health Agent, Integration, or Admin), and the optional expiry and notes.



3. Click Create Key and copy the raw key (prefixed bch-). It is shown only once.



Note: The key won't be displayed again. Copy it somewhere that you will be able to retrieve it later when it's time to deploy agents via the BigFix Console.

Step 5: Configure the BigFix Connection and Root CA

Agent Monitor cross-checks each endpoint against the BigFix REST API. For that to work over HTTPS, the dashboard must trust your BigFix Root Server's certificate. Each tenant carries its own Root CA, so you can host several BigFix environments side by side.

1. Go to Administration > System Settings > Connections and select the tenant in the sidebar.
2. On the BIGFIX ROOT SERVER card, enter the server URL, port (default 52311), and Master Operator credentials. Under BES ROOT CA CERTIFICATE, choose Capture from server, or Paste PEM and paste your Root CA, then Install pasted cert.
3. The setting takes effect immediately. You can then set “**Verify SSL Certificate**” to ‘Yes’
4. The dashboard reports success or the exact reason it failed.

BIGFIX ROOT SERVER ?

TENANTS

- Self-Sealing Stembolts, ...

Editing **Self-Sealing Stembolts, Inc.**

SERVER URL

https://bfrootsvr

PORT

52311

AUTHENTICATION METHOD

API Token

API TOKEN

(stored — leave blank to keep current)

VERIFY SSL CERTIFICATE ?

Yes — require a trusted certificate

BES ROOT CA CERTIFICATE ?

TRUSTED

SUBJECT

2.5.4.41=DBName:ServerSigningCertificate_0,2.5.4.41=Type:Administrator,CN=ServerSigningCertificate_0

SHA-256

4C:68:83:A3:4D:71:F3:BC:16:AD:78:74:FF:07:53:F6:2F:53:AF:0D:88:2C:99:4C:B2:1D:00:06:E6:A4:8E:42

EXPIRY

2033-12-08 (expires in 2702d)

INSTALLED

6/17/2026, 8:49:45 PM

Capture from server

Paste PEM...

Clear cert

Save BigFix settings

Test connection

Rotate all keys

Hide tenant

Validity-only check. The dashboard's cross-check is permissive on purpose. It will accept self-signed BigFix Root CAs and skip CN validation. The one thing it does reject is an expired certificate.

Step 6: Generate the Signing Certificate

The Windows Health Agent ships unsigned. Before you deploy it, you should sign it with a code-signing certificate that your organization owns and controls. Signing matters on Windows because the operating system verifies executable publishers natively: ***unsigned binaries trigger SmartScreen warnings, raise antivirus and EDR suspicion, and are blocked outright by application-control policies such as AppLocker.***

Why Isn't the Agent Signed by the Developer?

A developer-signed agent would mean that once you add the certificate to your trust store, your endpoints trust the developer's key, and whoever holds that key could sign anything your machines would accept. With your own certificate, that power never leaves your organization: you control what gets signed and you can replace the certificate at any time.

The dashboard does the signing for you. Under Administration > System Settings > Agent Builds, you either generate a new signing certificate (the dashboard creates a certificate authority and a 10-year signing certificate in one step) or provide your own signing certificate. The private key is used only for the moment of signing and is never stored on the server. If you created a specific signing certificate for this purpose in the dashboard UI, you download it once and keep it offline.

WINDOWS AGENT SIGNING ?

The dashboard holds the agent installer unsigned. Set up your certificate, sign the build, then distribute the signed installer and your CA certificate to your endpoints. The dashboard never keeps a copy of your signing key.

No signing certificate set up yet. Generate your own certificate authority (you keep and control it), or bring your own by signing a build below with an existing .pfx.

Your organization name

Passphrase to protect the key

Confirm passphrase

GENERATE SIGNING CA

- Enter the Org name the certificate will carry
- Enter the passphrase that someone must know to sign software with it
- Generate the Signing CA and download it. Note that you will not be able to download it again so store it (and the passphrase) in a safe place. Think of it the same way you think of your "license.pvk" and "license.crt" files for your BigFix environment.

Step 7: Sign The Windows Agent

After generating the signing certificate you must sign the Windows agent with it.

SIGNABLE AGENT BUILDS

IMPORT UNSIGNED BINARY...

VERSION	PLATFORM	STATE	SIGNED BY	SIGNED AT	ACTIONS
2.8.0.0	linux	ATTESTED	n/a	—	DOWNLOAD
2.8.0.0	windows	UNSIGNED	—	—	SIGN DOWNLOAD UNSIGNED

- Click “sign” and select your code signing certificate.
- Enter the passphrase and click “Sign”
- Click Close once the agent has been signed.

You will now see the signed agent available for download.

SIGNABLE AGENT BUILDS

IMPORT UNSIGNED BINARY...

VERSION	PLATFORM	STATE	SIGNED BY	SIGNED AT	ACTIONS
2.8.0.0	linux	ATTESTED	n/a	—	DOWNLOAD
2.8.0.0	windows	SIGNED	CN=Self-Sealing Stem bolts Corp. Code Signing,O=Self-Sealing Stem bolts Corp.	8/23/2026, 2:33:17 AM	RE-SIGN DOWNLOAD SIGNED DOWNLOAD UNSIGNED

You may also download an unsigned version if you wish to sign it offline instead of through this UI or if you wish to deploy the agent unsigned with the understanding that it will encounter trust issues with Windows app verification mechanisms.

Unsigned endpoints will also be displayed in the Dashboard as “Chain Invalid”

☐	HOSTNAME ▼	OS	COMPUTER ID	STATUS	AGENT PRIORITY	AGENT VER
☐	WIN22LABSERVER	WINDOWS	1081951465	HEALTHY  CHAIN INVALID	—	2.8.0.0
☐	WIN22LABRELAY	WINDOWS	14955610	HEALTHY  CHAIN INVALID	RELAY	2.8.0.0
☐	WIN10LAB1	WINDOWS	4745253	HEALTHY  CHAIN INVALID	CRITICAL	2.8.0.0

Using the signed download and the charter file you may manually install this agent on any Windows device.

Step 8: Set the Report Encryption Policy (Optional)

If you want diagnostic bundles encrypted end to end, set the policy now; otherwise skip this step and revisit it later. Go to Administration > System Settings > Report Encryption.

1. Set the Policy: Off (no encryption, the default), Optional (encrypt when the endpoint supports it, allow plaintext during a rolling migration), or Required (reject plaintext).
2. To vary it by tenant, use Per-tenant overrides, where each tenant inherits the global policy or sets its own.

REPORT ENCRYPTION ?

STRONGBOX ?

Policy

Required: reject plaintext (all endpoints must)

Per-tenant overrides ?

Optional: encrypt if capable, allow plaintext

Self-Sealing Stembolts, Inc.

Required: reject plaintext

Key-delivery anchor ?

c30e4cd611a81fd810da43ef46856c2471a1a0c824fa904a674c51e26fde1246

COPY

ML-DSA-65

Deploy this fingerprint to agents out-of-band (Fixlet parameter or `config.ini`) to let them verify key deliveries. Do not send it over the dashboard connection.

Enforcement readiness ?

All 11 agents are Ready (verifying key deliveries). Safe to enforce.

11

Ready

11

Enforced

0

Not set

0

Mismatch

0

Not reported

Current strongbox keys ?

TENANT	ACTIVE KEY_ID	CREATED	STATUS	ACTION
bftootsvr	2	5/23/2026, 1:25:31 AM	ACTIVE	<button>Rotate</button>
	1	7/9/2026, 8:14:40 AM	ACTIVE	<button>Rotate</button>

EMERGENCY: INVALIDATE ALL STRONGBOX KEYS

Deletes every tenant's strongbox keys. The dashboard regenerates a fresh keypair the next time any Health Agent requests one. Use this after a server-migration if the inherited keys are unreadable ("strongbox_stale_key" errors in ingest logs that don't clear after Health Agents re-fetch), or when responding to a suspected dashboard-host compromise. All Health Agents will hit one round of 409 and re-enroll cleanly on the next post.

Invalidate all strongbox keys...

Step 9: Stage the Agent Bundles on Your BigFix Console Workstation

The Health Agent installer reads the platform bundle and the charter. If you will deploy through BigFix, stage the bundle and the charter where the Console can read them:

Suggested layout on the operator workstation

```
C:\BigFix\agentmonitor\  
agentmonitor-linux-<version>.tar.gz  
AgentMon-Agent-<version>-windows.zip  
dashboard.charter
```

Part 3: Health Agent Installation

The Health Agent installs from a self-contained installer that reads the dashboard.charter you generated in Part 2. You can run it directly on an endpoint for a pilot, or deploy it at scale through a standard BigFix Fixlet. Both paths use the same installer and the same charter.

How the charter is used. Place dashboard.charter in the same folder as the installer, or pass it with the --charter option. The installer verifies the charter's signature before trusting anything in it. If the charter is missing or altered, verification fails and the installer falls back to asking for a dashboard URL and key.

Linux Health Agent

Copy the Linux bundle and the charter to the endpoint (or to a staging location a Fixlet will read), and extract the bundle:

```
tar -xzf agentmonitor-linux-<version>.tar.gz  
cd agentmonitor
```

Run the installer as root, with the charter alongside it:

```
sudo bash install.sh
```

The installer auto-detects dashboard.charter file, verifies it, and writes the enrollment settings into the agent configuration. If no charter is present and the console is interactive, it prompts instead and live-validates the values against the dashboard before continuing:

```
1. Dashboard URL (e.g. https://192.168.0.45):  
2. Agent API key (bch-...):
```

What the installer creates:

- Install directory: /opt/agentmonitor
- Configuration: /etc/agentmonitor/config.ini
- State and logs: /var/lib/bigfix-health-agent

- Service user: agentmonitor (system account, no shell)
- Units: agentmonitor.timer (backstop about every 10 minutes), agentmonitor.service, and agentmonitor-watchdog.service (event-driven)

Any older bigfix-health-agent units are stopped and removed automatically, and the endpoint's identity and history are preserved.

Windows Health Agent

Copy the Windows bundle to the endpoint and extract it. The self-contained installer, AgentMon-Agent-Setup.exe, is inside the AgentMon-Agent folder. Place dashboard.charter next to it, then run the installer as Administrator.

The agent is signed with the code-signing certificate your organization created in Part 2, Step 6; make sure that signing CA is trusted on the endpoint before installing (Group Policy, a BigFix Fixlet, or a manual certutil import). It auto-detects and verifies the charter, then installs. Run interactively with no charter, it prompts for the dashboard URL and key and live-validates them, exactly as the Linux installer does. Run silently or through a Fixlet, it never prompts.

What the installer creates:

- Install directory: C:\Program Files\AgentMonitor
- Agent executable: AgentMonitor.exe
- Agent task: \AgentMonitor (runs about every 15 minutes)
- Watchdog task: \AgentMonitor-Watchdog (repeats about every 10 minutes and at startup)

Any older \BigFix-HealthAgent tasks are removed automatically.

Deploying at Scale with BigFix

For a full rollout, deploy the same installer and charter through BigFix rather than touching endpoints by hand:

- Stage the platform bundle and dashboard.charter on the BES Root Server.
- Use a Fixlet to download both to the endpoint, extract, and run the installer non-interactively; it reads the charter and enrolls with no prompts.
- Target a small pilot computer group first (10 to 50 endpoints), confirm heartbeats and integrity badges appear, then expand.
- The installer is version-aware, re-running it against current endpoints upgrades them in-place.

Confirm Endpoints Are Reporting

Return to the web UI, open the Endpoints tab, and open any newly enrolled endpoint. Its last-heartbeat timestamp should be within the past few minutes.

ODEL3-ZORIN

X

METADATA

Hostname

ODEL3-ZORIN

Tenant

Self-Sealing Stembolts, Inc.

OS

linux · Zorin OS 18.1

IP address

192.168.0.169

BESClient version

11.0.6.137

BigFix Computer ID

6225502

Health Agent version

2.6.0.5

First seen

5/7/2026, 1:01:04 PM

Registered

5/7/2026, 1:01:04 PM

Last activity

7/16/2026, 10:49:06 PM (7s ago)

Last heartbeat

7/16/2026, 10:49:06 PM (7s ago)

Status at last report

HEALTHY ●

Status reasons

- BESClient running; last BES log entry at 7/16/2026 10:46:00 PM

Mean recovery time

7 m (23 episodes in last 60d)

Groups

All Endpoints

Mission Critical Devices

Agent Priority

☒ CRITICAL

Silent since

—

Uninstalled at

—

Notes

—

Confirm Integrity State

In the Endpoints list, integrity appears as a badge beside the health status, and only when something is wrong. A correctly installed agent shows no integrity badge at all: the clean state is silent. Three badges can appear: TAMPERED means the reported binary SHA-256 does not match the build attestation on file for that version and platform; CHAIN INVALID (Windows only) means the Authenticode signature does not chain to your organization's signing CA on the endpoint; UNKNOWN BUILD means no attestation is on file yet for that build. To confirm integrity after deployment, verify that newly enrolled endpoints show no integrity badge.

☐	HOSTNAME	OS	COMPUTER ID	STATUS	AGENT PRIORITY	AGENT VER	AUTH	REPORTING MODE	LAST HEARTBEAT
☐	ODEL3-ZORIN	LINUX	6225502	HEALTHY ●	CRITICAL	2.6.0.5	ENROLLED	ENCRYPTED	7/16/2026, 10:49:06 PM 13m ago

Part 4: DMZ Forwarder Installation (Optional)

Install a DMZ Forwarder only when some endpoints can't reach the dashboard directly, for example endpoints served by an internet-facing BigFix relay. The forwarder sits in the exposed network, accepts agent reports on TCP/31313, and relays them inward to the dashboard. It is a dumb pipe: it never reads or changes report contents, and it authenticates itself to the dashboard with its own key.

Step 1: Register the Forwarder in the Dashboard

In the web UI, go to Administration > System Settings > Forwarders and register a new forwarder with a name, and set Placement to DMZ (this Part 4 forwarder serves endpoints outside your network). The dashboard creates a forwarder key (prefixed bch-) for it. Enter the TLS names that agents will use to dial this forwarder; these become the subject-alternative-names in the forwarder's signed certificate. You can enter DNS names or, when you have no resolvable name, an IP address (IPv4 or IPv6).

FORWARDERS + CREATE NEW

CADENCE Heartbeat every 600 s SILENT after 180 s Save

SELF-SEALING STEMBOLTS, INC. 1 forwarder

NAME	HOSTNAME	STATUS	LAST HEARTBEAT	SPOOL	VERSION	ENDPOINTS	TLS CERT	KEY	ACTIONS
win22labrelay	Win22LABRelay	ONLINE	7/16/2026, 11:00:35 PM 2m ago	0	1.1.0.1	2	ISSUED win22labrelay exp 7/12/2036, 7:01:31 PM	bch-418486...	View key TLS names Use own cert Disable Revoke

Bring your own certificate (optional). If you prefer your own PKI for the forwarder's certificate, switch the forwarder to your own CA and supply the certificate. Otherwise the dashboard issues and renews the forwarder's certificate automatically.

Step 2: Install the Forwarder

On the Windows DMZ host defined in the UI, run AgentMonitorForwarder-Setup.exe. The self-contained installer stages the forwarder, validates the forwarder key against the dashboard, registers an auto-start Windows service, opens the Windows Firewall for inbound TCP/31313, starts the service, and confirms the listener is answering.

The values it needs are the upstream dashboard URL and the forwarder key from Step 1. Its configuration uses these sections and keys:

- [dashboard] api_url: upstream dashboard URL (for example https://dashboard.example.com:31313)
- [dashboard] verify_ssl: verify the dashboard's TLS certificate
- [forwarder] forwarder_key: the bch- forwarder key from Step 1
- [listener] bind, port: inbound bind address and port (default 0.0.0.0:31313)
- [tls] cert_mode: auto (dashboard-issued certificate) or byo (your own)

Step 3: Certificate Issuance (Automatic)

With `cert_mode = auto`, the forwarder generates a certificate signing request and submits it to the dashboard, which returns a signed certificate carrying the TLS names you set in Step 1. Renewal is automatic and hot-swaps the running listener with no restart. Agents learn to trust this authority through the charter's forwarder trust bundle and a self-healing push from the dashboard, so no manual certificate distribution to endpoints is needed.

If the certificate is not yet issued. If the dashboard can't be reached or no TLS names are set yet, the forwarder self-signs so its listener still comes up, and that leg stays unverified until a proper certificate is issued. Set the TLS names in Step 1 and the forwarder picks up its signed certificate on its next check-in.

Step 4: Point Endpoints at the Forwarder

In most deployments no endpoint configuration is needed: the dashboard sends every agent the current list of registered forwarders automatically. Each agent tests the connection to every one and uses the fastest forwarder that answers, preferring internal forwarders while on the corporate network and DMZ forwarders when off it.

You can steer routing in two ways. Per endpoint from the dashboard: open the endpoint's detail panel and use the routing control (Route via forwarder or Force dashboard)

AUTHENTICATION

Enrollment status	ENROLLED	Rotate key	Revoke enrollment	Hide endpoint
Tenant enrollment mode	auto			
Signature algorithm	ml-dsa-65			
Public key fingerprint	feaf:fa02:9700:f162:8ca7:d7ca:5b07:40e7			
Enrolled at	7/13/2026, 1:23:40 PM (3d ago)			
Approved at	7/13/2026, 1:23:40 PM (3d ago)			
Key last rotated	—			
Revoked at	—			
Report routing	reporting direct	Route via forwarder	Force dashboard	

The choice is applied on the endpoint's next heartbeat, with no Fixlet or config edit. At install time in the agent configuration: set `[dashboard] forwarder_url` to assign a specific forwarder, and optionally `prefer_forwarder = true` to route through it without probing the dashboard first. A dashboard routing choice overrides the config file's `prefer_forwarder` default (an explicit `forwarder_url` in the config still decides which forwarder is tried first). Agents fall back to a direct dashboard connection when possible and spool locally if neither path is available.

Verification

After completing the parts you deployed, run through this checklist to confirm everything is working as expected.

Dashboard Server

- 1. Services running.** Run `sudo systemctl status bigfix-health-archive` and `sudo systemctl status bigfix-health-archive-scheduler`; both should report active (running).
- 2. Health endpoint.** Run `curl -sk https://localhost/api/health | python3 -m json.tool` and confirm it returns status: healthy with every sub-check passing.
- 3. Web UI accessible.** Open `https://your-server-ip` in a browser and log in successfully.
- 4. BigFix connection.** On the Connections page, confirm Test connection succeeds and the last cross-check is recent.

Health Agent (Linux endpoint)

- 1. systemd timer exists.** Run `systemctl status agentmonitor.timer`
- 2. Watchdog daemon running.** Run `systemctl status agentmonitor-watchdog.service`
- 3. Identity preserved across upgrade.** If this endpoint was previously on the old bigfix-health-agent layout, confirm `/var/lib/bigfix-health-agent/identity.json` exists and the dashboard shows the same `agent_id` it had before. Endpoint history is preserved across the rename.

Health Agent (Windows endpoint)

- 1. Scheduled tasks exist.** Open Task Scheduler and confirm `\AgentMonitor` and `\AgentMonitor-Watchdog` are present and enabled.
- 2. Installed binary visible.** Confirm `C:\Program Files\AgentMonitor\AgentMonitor.exe` exists. Right-click and choose Properties to confirm File Version reads `<version>` and the Digital Signatures tab shows a valid signature from your organization's signing certificate.
- 3. Integrity state clean.** In the web UI, the endpoint shows no integrity badge beside its health status; a badge appears only when something is wrong.

DMZ Forwarder (if installed)

- Service running: the Agent Monitor Forwarder Windows service is running.
- Listener up: the forwarder answers on TCP/31313.
- Seen by the dashboard: the forwarder appears on the Forwarders page with a recent heartbeat, and its certificate shows as issued.

End-to-end loop

Confirm the dashboard sees a state change in real time.

1. Pick an endpoint that currently reports HEALTHY in the dashboard, and assign it Critical priority for the duration of the test (Endpoints page, Actions menu). Critical endpoints post state changes immediately; non-critical endpoints deliberately spread their posts over up to 10 minutes to protect the dashboard from synchronized surges.
2. Stop the BES Client on that endpoint
3. Within 30 to 60 seconds the watchdog daemon should detect the stop and fire a force-now run
4. The dashboard should flip the endpoint to UNHEALTHY within roughly 30 seconds of the BES Client stopping
5. Start the BES Client again. The dashboard should flip back to HEALTHY on the next heartbeat

Troubleshooting

Common installation and post-install issues.

Dashboard Server

Symptom	Cause	Resolution
Service fails to start	Varies; the journal names the exact error	<code>sudo journalctl -u bigfix-health-archive -n 100</code>
502 Bad Gateway in the browser	App not running, OR warmup window not yet complete	Wait 60 seconds; if still failing, check journalctl
BES Cross-Check returns 0 endpoints	Operator is not a Master Operator	Re-create the BigFix operator with MO role
BES Cross-Check fails with SSL error	Tenant Root CA not uploaded, or expired	Re-capture or re-paste the Root CA: Administration > System Settings > Connections, select the tenant, BES ROOT CA CERTIFICATE card
SSL certificate warning in browser	Self-signed cert (expected)	Replace with a trusted cert in Step 6 of Part 1
Can't reach BigFix server from dashboard	Network or firewall block	<code>curl -sk https://bigfix-server:52311</code> from the dashboard host
Database connection error	PostgreSQL not running	<code>sudo systemctl status postgresql</code>
Hostname change broke credentials	.env credentials are encrypted under a key derived from machine-id + hostname; after a rename the ciphertext no longer decrypts	<code>cd /opt/bigfix-health-archive && sudo venv/bin/python -m app.scripts.rotate_credentials --old-hostname OLD</code> , then restart both services. Works even after a failed restart; a timestamped .env backup is taken automatically.

Health Agent (general)

Symptom	Cause	Resolution
Fixlet runs, endpoint not visible in dashboard	Charter invalid or missing	Re-stage a valid dashboard.charter, or supply the URL and key when prompted
Endpoint shows REVOKED	Identity was revoked from the dashboard side	Select the endpoint and click Restore (in the Endpoints list bulk bar or the endpoint detail panel); it re-enrolls cleanly on its next post
Endpoint shows TAMPERED integrity state	Binary SHA-256 does not match the build attestation	Confirm the bundle on the Console workstation matches the distribution checksum; redeploy
Endpoint shows CHAIN INVALID	Agent build is unsigned, or signature doesn't chain to your org's signing CA on the endpoint.	Sign the Windows build under Agent Builds and distribute your CA certificate to endpoints.
Endpoint reports SILENT despite being online	Agent not firing on its timer	Check the OS scheduler entry; see the platform-specific tables below

Health Agent (Linux specific)

Symptom	Cause	Resolution
Timer not firing	Timer was not enabled	<code>systemctl enable --now agentmonitor.timer</code>
Agent crashes on first run	identity.json owned by wrong user	<code>chown agentmonitor:agentmonitor /var/lib/bigfix-health-agent/identity.json</code>
CRYPTO_BROKEN.txt present in /var/lib/bigfix-health-agent/	Runtime crypto self-check failed at startup	Reinstall the agent with the install directory excluded from AV real-time scanning; the install-time crypto check reports which submodule is missing
Agent service fails (exit status 2), log shows enrollment deferred and 401	BES Client not installed or not yet reporting on this endpoint	Install the BES Client; the agent enrolls and reports on its next timer run

Health Agent (Windows specific)

Symptom	Cause	Resolution
Install fails or reports the charter as rejected; files missing under AgentMon-Agent	AV likely interrupted the bundle extraction or copy	Exclude C:\temp\agentmonitor and the install directory from real-time scanning, re-take the action, confirm the whole AgentMon-Agent folder extracted
AgentMonitor.exe blocked by SmartScreen	Build is unsigned, or your signing CA is not yet trusted on this endpoint	Sign the build and distribute the CA certificate first. For manual installs use the installer's CA-import
Scheduled task missing or disabled	Install partially failed	Check the Fixlet output; re-take action
regapp inspector does not see the application	By design: the installer registers scheduled tasks, not an Add/Remove Programs (HKLM Uninstall) entry	Use a BigFix version-of-file inspector against AgentMonitor.exe, or Task Scheduler, to confirm the agent is installed
AgentMonitor not visible in Add or Remove Programs	Same as above	Use Task Scheduler to confirm the agent is installed

Log file locations

Component	Log location
Dashboard application	<code>sudo journalctl -u bigfix-health-archive</code>
Dashboard Nginx access	<code>/var/log/nginx/access.log</code>
Dashboard Nginx error	<code>/var/log/nginx/error.log</code>
Dashboard installer	install.log (in the extracted tarball directory)
Linux Health Agent	<code>/var/lib/bigfix-health-agent/agent.log</code>
Linux Watchdog daemon	<code>sudo journalctl -u agentmonitor-watchdog.service</code>
Windows Health Agent	<code>C:\Program Files\AgentMonitor\agent.log</code>
Windows installer (Fixlet)	BigFix action log on the endpoint

Managing the Application

Service management (Dashboard)

bash

```
# Check status
sudo systemctl status bigfix-health-archive

# Restart the service
sudo systemctl restart bigfix-health-archive

# Stop the service
sudo systemctl stop bigfix-health-archive

# View recent logs
sudo journalctl -u bigfix-health-archive -n 200

# Follow logs in real time
sudo journalctl -u bigfix-health-archive -f

# Check the background job scheduler (cross-checks, alerts, retention)
sudo systemctl status bigfix-health-archive-scheduler
```

```
# Restart the scheduler  
sudo systemctl restart bigfix-health-archive-scheduler
```

The dashboard also runs a separate scheduler service, `bigfix-health-archive-scheduler`, which runs the silent detector, alerting, and the BigFix cross-check. Restart it alongside the main service after an upgrade.

Database backup (from the web UI)

1. Click **Administration > System Settings > Backup and Restore**
2. Click **Create Backup**
3. Download the resulting `.sql` file for off-site storage

Backup format. Backups are plain `pg_dump` `.sql` files stored under `/opt/bigfix-health-archive/backups/`. Restore is destructive (it drops and recreates the database); a pre-restore safety backup is always taken automatically first, so you can roll back.

Upgrading the dashboard

When a new dashboard release ships, you will receive a new tarball. The installer detects an existing install and switches to upgrade mode:

1. Extract the new tarball into a fresh directory
2. Run `sudo bash install.sh` as before
3. The installer preserves your `.env` (BigFix credentials, SMTP creds, app secret), the SSL certificate, the admin password, and all of the database contents
4. Application code is replaced; database migrations are applied automatically

Upgrading the Health Agent

Agent upgrades use the same Fixlet you used for first-time deployment. When a new agent version ships:

1. Replace the bundles on your Console workstation with the new versions
2. Update the Fixlet's version number
3. Take action against your target computer group
4. The Fixlet's relevance gate only fires against endpoints below the new version, so re-taking action is safe

Linux Health Agent management (per endpoint)

bash

```
# Service status
systemctl status agentmonitor.timer
systemctl status agentmonitor-watchdog.service

# Force an immediate check-in (posts to the dashboard right away)
sudo /opt/agentmonitor/agentmonitor \
    --config /etc/agentmonitor/config.ini --check-in

# View the agent log
sudo tail -f /var/lib/bigfix-health-agent/agent.log
```

Windows Health Agent management (per endpoint)

PowerShell

```
# Task status
Get-ScheduledTask -TaskName "AgentMonitor"
Get-ScheduledTask -TaskName "AgentMonitor-Watchdog"

# Force an immediate check-in
& "C:\Program Files\AgentMonitor\AgentMonitor.exe" --check-in

# Disable temporarily
Disable-ScheduledTask -TaskName "AgentMonitor"
Enable-ScheduledTask -TaskName "AgentMonitor"

# View the agent log
Get-Content "C:\Program Files\AgentMonitor\agent.log" -Tail 50 -Wait
```


Uninstalling

To remove the dashboard, run `sudo bash uninstall.sh` from the extracted bundle. It stops and removes the services, removes the Nginx site, drops the database and role, and removes the application directory, TLS certificate, internal CA, sudoers rule, and service account. Add **--keep-db** to preserve the database and its data for a future reinstall, or **--dry-run** to preview the changes without removing anything. PostgreSQL and Nginx themselves are left installed.

To remove the Health Agent from an endpoint: on Linux, run `sudo bash install.sh --uninstall` from the extracted bundle; on Windows, run `AgentMon-Agent-Setup.exe --uninstall` as Administrator. Either can be deployed at scale through a BigFix Fixlet. The agent posts a goodbye on the way out and the endpoint hides itself from the dashboard automatically.